node `C` and `B` are though checked to decide if they should be included in the results.

These queries are common in business applications, and many databases support optimized techniques to speed them up: while you won't find it in MySQL, PostgreSQL supports NN search indexes since version 9, and Oracle implements them in *Extensible Indexing*.

When indexing tables with a single key field (and many non-key fields), we can use a binary search tree to provide fast (logarithmic) lookup in searches based on the indexed field.







